Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

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Automatic Revalidation

Automatic revalidation provides that, under certain circumstances, a person with an expired F or J visa in their passport can reenter the United States from Canada, Mexico and adjacent islands (except Cuba). The absence outside the United States cannot exceed 30 days and the I-94 Arrival/Departure Record must remain valid.

Please check the visa requirements for the country you are traveling to before making travel arrangements. You may require a visa to enter certain countries based on the passport you hold.

Please learn more on the U.S. Department of State website.

Jump to a Section

Requirements for Automatic Re

To reenter the United States under the benef scholars meet the following requirements.

- Must have traveled only to Canada, Mexico or adjacent islands.

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and must have a valid visa for reentry.

Back to Top

Travel by Cruise Ship

Students or scholars traveling to Mexico or the Caribbean by cruise ship must contact the cruise line before purchasing their cruise package. Not all cruise lines recognize automatic visa revalidation. Confirm that the cruise line will allow travel and reentry to the United States without a valid F-1 or J-1 visa.

Back to Top

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